Burial Mound of Kaghan

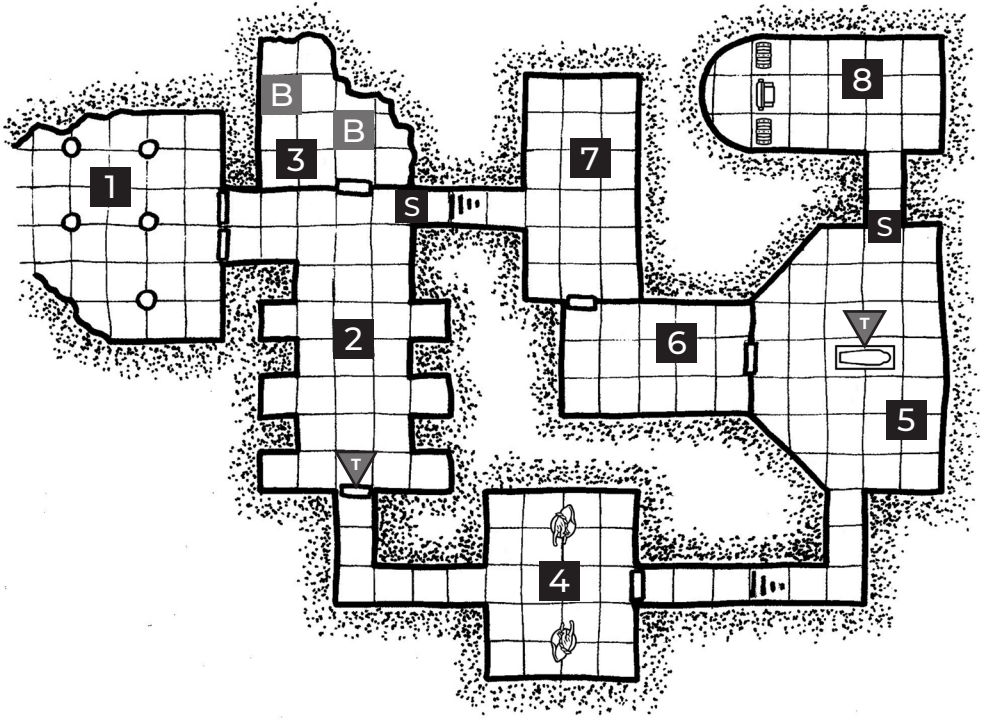
The tomb of the Kyzian Prince Kaghan lies open to the sky for plunder!

Kaghan the Bewitched went to his grave surrounded by splendor in the hopes his malevolent soul would finally rest, leaving his people in peace. But an **earthquake** has cracked the tomb's ancient seal, and now a wind blows cold and black from within its fabled halls!

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	Silent **ghost** of a charging horse
2	1d4 grave robbers (**bandits**) who set off traps and bumble around
3	2d4 **shadows** that weep and wail
4	**The Wandering Merchant** (once only) looking for a "blue goblet"

Goblet of Kaghan. A royal blue chalice dotted with sapphires. Once a decade, water poured into it becomes a *Potion of Legendary Deeds*. The imbiber becomes possessed by Kaghan's tyrannical spirit on each full moon.



T Trapped

S Secret Door

Shadowdark RPG

5th-Level

K. Dionne, 2026

1. Entrance Hall. A fissure opens in the side of a broad burial mound. Within are partially collapsed walls, oppressive silence, and the smell of wet earth. Five **pillars** carved with charging horses hold up the ceiling. Each pillar has a **secret compartment** housing a bronze spear; one is a *+1 spear* called Zugul that beads constantly with blood. A chaotic wielder treats it as a *+3 spear* as long as it was used that day to slay a living humanoid.

2. Hall of Murals. Peeling **frescoes** cover the walls; they depict mounted warriors clashing on grassy plains and people fleeing from burning tents. The **alcoves** show scenes of a bearded, robed warrior (Kaghan) spearing a lion, shooting his bow from horseback, and drinking ceremoniously from a blue goblet.

- **Trap.** When south door opens, poison needles shoot from tiny holes in the alcoves. DC 15 CON if in line of fire or STR stat drops to 3 (-4) for 10 rounds.
- **Secret Door.** Sliding wall panel behind a fresco of a rearing horse.

3. Collapsed Chamber. Walls collapse onto decrepit bags of grain, clay jars of salt, and ruptured barrels of spoiled beer. Two tired human **bandits** (Samsar and Hibusu) pick through the rubble, grumbling about the lack of treasure. They pretend to know all about the tomb and will "guide" the PCs for a fee.

4. Horse Idols. Two bronze **statues** of actual-sized warhorses flank the room. They are examples of equine perfection; each wears bell-draped war barding. The statues begin to warm to the touch each round people are present. After 3 rounds, they erupt into fire and motion, becoming a pair of hostile **nightmares**.

5. False Tomb. A bronze **sarcophagus** (actually wood covered in a thin shell of metal) lies on a stone bier. It is **trapped**; opening it releases a green hallucination gas in near range (DC 15 CON or attack the nearest creature for 1d4 rounds). Inside, a skeleton in red robes lies in a pool of 300 gold coins (actually chips of gold-dipped lead worth 10 gp total).

- **Secret Door.** A rotating stone panel.

6. Wives' Tomb. The faint hiss of cruel whispers and gossip fills the room. **Wall niches** contain the bones of 8 women wrapped in decayed black silk. One wears a *Scarab of Protection* (if taken, all the bones coalesce into a **bone naga** that howls with 8 womens' voices).

7. Servants' Tomb. Dozens of **wall niches** packed with crumbling, dried clay hold bound skeletons interred alive.

8. Kaghan's Tomb. A skeleton in red silk robes sits upright on a bronze throne carved with galloping horses (120 gp, 3 gear slots). The skeleton clutches a **blue goblet** dotted with sapphires (the *Goblet of Kaghan,* 200 gp). Two bronze **treasure chests** flank the throne.

- **Treasure Chests.** Expertly locked (DC 20 DEX to open). One contains 10 gold-dipped skulls (50 gp each). The other holds *Bracers of Archery*, 500 gp, and a clay tablet with an official lineage tree revealing one of the PCs is Kaghan's most direct living heir.
- **Collapse.** If someone takes the *Goblet of Kaghan*, a dark wind rises. The skeleton on the throne rattles and lets out a piercing scream. The earth begins shaking; the whole tomb **collapses** in 4 rounds, causing 10d6 damage to anyone still inside.